



FAMILY EMERGENCY PLAN

A Simple Guide to Preparing Your Household

Prepare before the emergency. Know what to do, where to go, and how to reconnect.

1. Know Your Household

Start by identifying who is in your household and what each person may need during an emergency.

Household / Family Name	
Home Address	
Primary Phone	
Emergency Meeting Place	

Family members and special needs (children, older adults, pets, medications, mobility needs, communication needs, and anything else to consider):

Notes

2. Decide How You Will Communicate

Choose one person outside your immediate area as a family contact. If local phone service is disrupted, family members can try contacting the same person and leaving updates.

Out-of-Area Contact	
Phone	
Secondary Contact	
Phone	

Family communication rule: If we become separated, we will first _____, then _____.

3. Choose Meeting Places

Choose places before an emergency occurs. Make sure every household member knows where they are.

Near Home	
Outside the Neighborhood	
Outside the City / Area	

4. Plan for Different Emergencies

Your family may need different actions depending on the situation. Decide ahead of time what you will do.

Situation	Our Plan
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Fire / Home Evacuation	Where will we go?
Severe Weather	Where is our safest shelter?
Power Outage	What will we rely on?
Water / Utility Disruption	What is our backup plan?
Evacuation Order	Where will we go, and what route?
Stay-at-Home Emergency	How will we communicate and manage supplies?

5. Build a Household Emergency Kit

Identify what your household needs to function for a period of time without normal services. Adjust the list to your family.

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Water and food | ☐ Important documents and emergency contacts |
| ☐ Medications and basic first-aid supplies | ☐ Basic hygiene and sanitation supplies |
| ☐ Flashlights and extra batteries | ☐ Clothing and blankets |
| ☐ Phone chargers / backup power | ☐ Pet supplies, if applicable |
| ☐ Battery or hand-crank radio | ☐ Infant, elderly, disability, or other special-needs supplies |

6. Important Information

Keep a current copy of important information in a secure place that household members can access.

Primary Doctor / Clinic	
Pharmacy	
School / Childcare	
Insurance Contact	
Utility Contacts	
Other Important Contact	

7. Evacuation & Transportation Plan

Determine how each household member will leave if evacuation is necessary. Consider vehicles, people without transportation, children, pets, and alternate routes.

Primary Vehicle	
Backup Transportation	
Primary Route	
Alternate Route	
Destination	

8. Assign Family Responsibilities

Give each person an age-appropriate responsibility so the plan does not depend on one person.

Person	Responsibility

9. Prepare, Practice, Update

A plan only works if your household knows the plan. Review it together and practice key steps.

- ☐ Review the plan with everyone in the household.

☐ Update contact information when it changes.
- ☐ Make sure children know who to contact and where to meet.

☐ Review medications and special-needs supplies.
- ☐ Check emergency supplies regularly.

☐ Practice your evacuation and communication plan.

Family Plan Review

Date Plan Created	
Last Review	
Next Review	
Person Responsible for Updates	

BUILD YOUR ARK
“Preparedness is wisdom in advance.”